

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS----- X
DANETTE COLBERT as Proposed Guardian of
LINCOLN NAGGIE,**SUMMONS**

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE
NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, FDNY FIRE
MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER, FDNY
LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA, NYPD POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10, and FDNY
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10,Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

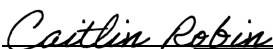
Defendants.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
July 26, 2021

Yours, etc.



CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD DETECTIVE NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, Criminal Enterprise
Investigations Section; 1 Police Plaza, New York, NY 10038

FDNY FIRE MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER, Ladder 123; 1352 St. Johns Place,
Brooklyn, NY 11213

FDNY LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA, Ladder 123; 1352 St. Johns Place,
Brooklyn, NY 11213

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

DANETTE COLBERT as Proposed Guardian of
LINCOLN NAGGIE,

INDEX NO.:

Plaintiff, VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE
NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, FDNY FIRE
MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER, FDNY
LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA, NYPD POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10, and FDNY
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10,**JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On November 5, 2020, at approximately 9:00 p.m., plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE, while lawfully in the vicinity of 948 Eastern Parkway in Brooklyn, New York, was subject to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. Plaintiff was unlawfully imprisoned at the 84th Precinct Police Station and Kings County Central Bookings for approximately five days before he was released on his own recognizance pursuant to CPL Section 180.80, as the DA failed to secure an indictment against the plaintiff as he committed no crime. Plaintiff was denied the right to due process and a fair trial for false charges, which were dismissed and sealed on or around March 8, 2021. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, confined, subjected to excessive force, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE is a resident of the state of New York.
3. Plaintiff DANETTE COLBERT is the natural mother of LINCOLN NAGGIE.
4. Plaintiff DANETTE COLBERT is the Proposed Guardian of LINCOLN NAGGIE.
5. NYPD DETECTIVE NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
6. NYPD DETECTIVE NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 71st Precinct.
7. NYPD DETECTIVE NELSON PINELA, Shield No. 4915, is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
8. FDNY FIRE MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Fire Department.
9. FDNY FIRE MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Ladder 123 Fire Station.
10. FDNY FIRE MARSHALL KENNETH HETTWER is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
11. FDNY LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Fire Department.
12. FDNY LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Ladder 123 Fire Station.
13. FDNY LIEUTENANT JOSEPH CAVARETTA is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
14. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
15. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 were at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 71st and 83rd Precincts.

16. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

17. FDNY OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Fire Department.

18. FDNY OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 were at all times relevant herein, assigned to the Ladder 123 Fire Station.

19. FDNY OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

20. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department and the New York City Fire Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police and Fire Departments at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police and Fire Departments and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police and Fire Departments.

21. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement, and a fire department, which acts as its agent of fire safety and emergency response, and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police and Fire Departments.

22. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

23. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on May 6, 2021.

24. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

25. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

26. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

27. On November 5, 2020, at approximately 9:00 P.M., Plaintiff was lawfully present in the vicinity of 948 Eastern Parkway in Brooklyn, New York, when the defendant police and fire officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, and falsely arrested Plaintiff without probable cause or legal justification.

28. Approximately one month prior to his arrest, on October 9, 2020, the plaintiff was outside his apartment building, The Institute for Community Living, located at 948 Eastern Parkway when he heard the fire alarm begin to sound inside the building.

29. Plaintiff remained outside the building as defendant NYC police and fire officers arrived on the scene.

30. The plaintiff was accused by defendant officers of having started a fire, and was sent to a nearby hospital for approximately two weeks until he could be placed in another community living facility.

31. Plaintiff was finally relocated to Walit House, a community living facility located at 415-417 State Street in Brooklyn.

32. On November 5, 2020, defendant officers came to Walit House and again questioned the plaintiff about his involvement in the fire on October 9th, 2020.

33. It was at this point that the defendant NYPD officers began to unlawfully arrest the plaintiff, restraining him with metal handcuffs and subjecting him to an unlawful pat-down search.

34. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

35. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

36. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

37. The Defendant Officers then placed the Plaintiff in the back of an NYPD vehicle and transported him against his will to the 84th Precinct police station, where he was unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed, searched, and placed in a holding cell.

38. After over 24 hours at the 84th Precinct, the plaintiff was transported to Kings County Central Bookings, where he was again fingerprinted, photographed, searched, and placed in a holding cell.

39. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

40. The defendant police and fire officers provided the District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

41. Specifically, the defendant police and fire officers falsely stated to the District Attorney's Office that the plaintiff was guilty of Arson in the second degree and Reckless Endangerment in the second degree, as well as Criminal Intent to Damage Property.

42. Thereafter, Plaintiff appeared in criminal court and his bail was set at \$20,000.00, even though the plaintiff had no prior arrest or conviction record.

43. On or around November 11, 2020, after approximately five days in police custody, the plaintiff was released from custody on his own recognizance after the Kings County District Attorney failed to secure an indictment, pursuant to CPL Section 180.80.

44. The charges which were falsely made against the Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed on or around March 8, 2021, as plaintiff committed no crime.

45. Some of the police and fire officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, using excessive force, falsely arresting and imprisoning, humiliating, and denying Plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial.

46. The unlawful search, seizure, use of excessive force, false arrest and imprisonment, and denial of Plaintiff's right to a fair trial by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

47. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 44 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

48. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

49. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

50. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 48 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

51. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

52. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

53. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

54. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

55. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

56. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 55 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

57. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning, and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

58. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

59. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

60. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

61. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

62. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 60 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

63. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

64. Defendants lacked probable cause to search Plaintiff.

65. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

66. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

67. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

68. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights****Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

69. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 67 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

70. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

71. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

72. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

73. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

74. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

75. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

76. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

77. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

78. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 76 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

79. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, tightly handcuffing him, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

80. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

81. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 79 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

82. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff, LINCOLN NAGGIE. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

83. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

84. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

85. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

86. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

87. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

88. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 86 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

89. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police and fire officer duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

90. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

91. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 89 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

92. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

93. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

94. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to strip search and other physical constraints.

95. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

96. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police and Fire Departments, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

97. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

98. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

99. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs 1 through 97 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

100. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the State of New York and the New York State common law.

101. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against the plaintiff.

102. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for the charges for which they were prosecuted.

103. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

104. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate Plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

105. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

106. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

107. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical, economic, and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

108. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff LINCOLN NAGGIE demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
July 26, 2021

By: Caillin Robin
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

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Brooklyn, NY 11213

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CAITLIN ROBIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the

State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
July 26, 2021


CAITLIN ROBIN